

Company Overview: SikaFlow

1. Company Description

SikaFlow is a Ghana-based fintech company that focuses on providing secure and easy-to-use digital payment services. The platform allows users to send and receive money, pay bills, and make payments to merchants through both mobile and web applications. The main goal of SikaFlow is to make financial transactions simple, fast, and accessible to people across Africa. SikaFlow differentiates itself by offering instant, low-cost cross-border payments across West Africa and supports both smartphone and USSD-based transactions, making it accessible to both urban and rural users.

2. Industry

SikaFlow operates in the financial technology (fintech) industry, specifically in digital payments and mobile money services.

3. Business Model

The company makes money by charging small transaction fees on transfers and payments. It also earns revenue from merchants using the platform and from businesses that integrate with its APIs or businesses that want to connect their apps with SikaFlow.

4. Company Size

SikaFlow is a medium-sized startup with about 120 employees, and it is currently expanding its services across West Africa.

5. Departments

The company is made up of several departments that handle different functions, including:

- Engineering (software development)
- IT Operations (infrastructure and systems)
- Cybersecurity (security of systems and data)
- Customer Support (handling customer inquiries)
- Finance & Compliance
- Product Management
- Sales & Partnerships
- Human Resources (responsible for recruiting new employees)

6. Core Business Functions

The main activities carried out by SikaFlow include:

- Registering users and verifying their identity via Know Your Customer (KYC)
- Creating and managing digital wallets
- Processing money transfers between users
- Handling merchant and bill payments
- Managing transactions and keeping records
- Monitoring the system for fraud or suspicious activities

- Providing APIs for third-party integrations

7. Digital Infrastructure Overview

SikaFlow runs on a cloud-based system. It has mobile applications for users, a web platform for both users and administrators, backend servers that handle requests, and databases that store user and transaction data. All these systems work together to support the platform's operations.

8. Users / Actors

Different types of people interact with the system, such as:

- Customers using the mobile app
- Merchants receiving payments
- System administrators managing the platform
- Customer support staff assisting users
- Third-party developers using the APIs

9. Data Handled

SikaFlow handles different types of data, including:

- Personal information of users (PII)
- Financial and transaction data
- Login and authentication data (passwords, OTPs, tokens)
- Business and merchant data
- System logs and activity records

10. Compliance and Security Requirements

As a fintech company, SikaFlow is expected to follow data protection and security standards. This includes complying with the Ghana Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843) and applying basic security practices such as secure authentication and data protection.

11. Threat Landscape

Because SikaFlow deals with money and sensitive data, it can be a target for different types of attacks. These include fraud, unauthorized access to accounts, data breaches, API abuse, insider threats, and denial of service attacks.

12. High-Level System Components

The main components of the system include:

- Mobile application
- Web application
- API gateway
- Authentication system
- Payment processing system
- Database servers

